SS-B-663b
June 9, 1965

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. SS-B-00663a (GSA-FSS)
September 9, 1963, and
Fed. Spec. SS-B-663
June 28, 1932

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRICK, BUILDING, CONCRETE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers solid concrete brick for use in masonry work.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Grades.* Concrete brick shall be of the following grades as specified (see 6.2):

Grade A—Brick subject to temperatures below freezing in presence of moisture (Severe weathering).

Grade B—Brick used as back-up or interior masonry (Negligible weathering).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147—Palletized Unit Loads (40" x 48" 4-Way Partial and 4-Way Pallets).

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials Publications:

C 55—Specification for Concrete Building Brick.

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C 140—Standard Methods of Sampling and Testing Concrete Masonry Units.

(Copies may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Each grade of concrete brick shall meet the requirements of ASTM C 55.

3.2 **Size.** The size of brick shall be as specified (see 6.2 and 6.3).

3.3 **Color and texture.** Color and texture of the brick shall be as commercially manufactured (see 6.2 and 6.4).

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **Responsibility for inspection.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Sampling.** The size of lot and samples for visual examination, dimensional characteristics, and test shall be in accordance with ASTM C 140.

4.3 **Test.** Brick shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C 140.

4.4 **Inspection of preparation for delivery.** The packing and marking of the bricks shall be inspected to determine conformance with the applicable requirements of section 5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Levels A and B.* The bricks shall be palletized into unit loads in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-147.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The bricks shall be packed to assure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination at the lowest rate.

5.2 **Marking.**

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** The concrete bricks covered by this specification are intended for use in masonry work where a brick manufactured from concrete is required.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Grade of brick desired (1.2.1).

(*c*) Size of brick desired (3.1 and 6.3).

(*d*) Color and texture of brick if different from 3.2.

(*e*) Level of packing required (5.1).

(*f*) Marking required (5.2).

6.3 **Size.** The standard size of brick is 2-1/4 by 3-3/4 by 8 inches. This size is not available in all sections of the country. Users should ascertain their required size and check sources for availability.

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6.4 Color and texture. If bricks of a particular color, finish or uniformity are desired they should be specified.

6.5 Transportation description. The transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Brick, building, concrete.
Carload minimum weight 60,000 pounds.

Motor:

Brick, building, concrete.
Truckload minimum weight 60,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—MO(ERDL)

Navy—YD

Air Force—69

Review Interest:

MO YD 69

User Interest:

MR MU CG

Copies of this specification may be purchased for s each.

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